

Unique wildlife

California

A Mediterranean-type climate results in some unique forests featuring the world's largest living organism—the giant sequoia, a gigantic species of coniferous tree.

Mexican pine-oak forests

These forests on Mexican mountain ridges are patches of habitat not found anywhere else nearby. There are nearly 4,000 endemic plants and unique birds such as the Montezuma quail.

Hawaii and Polynesia

Only certain life-forms have reached these remote islands. Hawaii has no ants, but has 500 species of unique fruit flies, all evolved from a single species blown ashore 8 million years ago. Some of them are flightless and have taken up antlike lifestyles. Hawaii also has many unique plants, including the strange Hawaiian silversword, endemic to its mountaintops.

Galápagos Islands

These islands were made famous by Charles Darwin for their unique wildlife, including their giant tortoises.

Tropical Andes

Perhaps the richest region on Earth, these mountains are home to 664 species of amphibians, 450 of which are in danger of dying out. Of 1,700 bird species, 600—including this fiery-throated fruiteater—are found nowhere else.

Some parts of the world are home to animals and plants that live nowhere else. These places are often remote islands, where life is cut off. In other cases, they are patches of unusual habitat, complete with the unique wildlife that depends on it.

Western Mediterranean

Europe's hot spot of unique wildlife. One species of midwife toad lives only on Majorca, and Barbary macaques live only on Gibraltar and in patches of habitat in Morocco and Algeria.

Canary Islands

Rich in endemic plants, the Canary Islands off Africa gave their name to the bird that lives only here and on nearby Atlantic islands—the canary.

Caribbean Islands

Each island has its own versions of many plants and animals. This Cuban knight anole lives only on Cuba.

Atlantic Forest

This thin strip of rainforest is cut off from the Amazon rainforest, so it has its own set of wildlife, including the endangered golden lion tamarin.

**75 PERCENT OF THE UNIQUE
PLANTS OF THE CANARY ISLANDS
ARE ENDANGERED**

NEARLY 7 PERCENT OF THE WORLD'S PLANTS ARE UNIQUE TO THE